object of cognition as shown by Saṅkara, who retains both the self-luminosity as well as the objectivity of cognitions and yields to none in his opposition to the 'Vijnānavada' subjectivist. To say that cognitions are grasped immediately and simultaneously along with the objects cognized is not to say that cognitions and their extra-mental substratum are identical, which is the conclusion feared by the anti-subjectivist. Nor to say that cognitions are self-luminous is to maintain with the Buddhist 'Vijnānavāda' his theory of the non-reality of objects apart from the cognitions. Yet the two contentions above have often been unfortunately confused and taken as necessarily implying one another, and philosophers with the exception of Śaṅkara and Prabhākara, have not taken pains to separate the two distinct issues of the self-cognizability of cognitions and of an absolute subjectivity of cognitions. The former, as an epistemological problem is far narrower in scope than the latter problem of the ontological status of objects. The epistemological doctrine of the self-cognizability of cognitions can in no way be identified with a metaphysical doctrine of the mental solipsism of reality.

Kumārila is therefore inconsistent, for either the cognitions are not intrinsically valid or they are also intrinsically cognizable. He cannot have it both ways, namely, retain 'Svaparamāṇatva' and destroy 'Svaprakāṣatva,' for the two notions stand or fall together. It is refreshing to note in this connection that Prabhākara, who fully shares with Kumārila his theory of the self-validity of cognitions as well as his opposition to the subjectivist Vijnānavāda, consistently maintains, unlike Kumārila, the theory of the self-luminosity of cognitions.

NOTES

1. S.V. Sūtra II.
2. Shri Krishna Saksena, *Nature of Consciousness in Hindu Philosophy.* (Banaras: Nand Kishore and Sons, 1944).